National
Qualifications
2026

X849/76/11

Modern Studies
Paper 1

TUESDAY, 19 MAY
9:00 AM – 10:45 AM

Total marks — 52

SECTION 1 — DEMOCRACY IN SCOTLAND AND THE UNITED KINGDOM — 20 marks

Attempt **ONE** question from 1 (a) **OR** 1 (b) **OR** 1 (c).

SECTION 2 — SOCIAL ISSUES IN THE UNITED KINGDOM — 20 marks

Part A Social inequality

Part B Crime and the law

Attempt **ONE** question from 2 (a) **OR** 2 (b) **OR** 2 (c) **OR** 2 (d).

SECTION 3 — INTERNATIONAL ISSUES — 12 marks

Part C World powers

Part D World issues

Attempt **ONE** question from 3 (a) **OR** 3 (b) **OR** 3 (c) **OR** 3 (d).

Write your answers clearly in the answer booklet provided. In the answer booklet you must clearly identify the question number you are attempting.

Use **blue** or **black** ink.

You must leave your answer booklet on your desk; if you do not, you could lose all the marks for this paper.

Qualifications Scotland
Teisteanasan Alba

X8497611

MARKS

SECTION 1 — DEMOCRACY IN SCOTLAND AND THE UNITED KINGDOM — 20 marks

Attempt **ONE** question from 1 (a) **OR** 1 (b) **OR** 1 (c)

Question 1

(a) Parliament is limited in its ability to check the power of government.
Discuss.
You should refer to Scotland **or** the United Kingdom **or** both in your answer. **20**

OR

(b) The electoral systems used in the UK are ineffective at providing fair representation.
Discuss.
You should refer to Scotland **or** the United Kingdom **or** both in your answer. **20**

OR

(c) The methods that pressure groups use determine their ability to successfully influence government decision-making.
Discuss.
You should refer to Scotland **or** the United Kingdom **or** both in your answer. **20**

[Now go to SECTION 2 on *page 03*]

MARKS

SECTION 2 — SOCIAL ISSUES IN THE UNITED KINGDOM — 20 marks

Attempt **ONE** question from 2 (a) **OR** 2 (b) **OR** 2 (c) **OR** 2 (d)

Question 2

Part A: Social inequality

Answers may refer to Scotland **or** the United Kingdom **or** both.

(a) To what extent are some factors more important than others in causing income and wealth inequality? **20**

OR

(b) To what extent have government attempts to reduce inequality been successful? **20**

OR

Part B: Crime and the law

Answers may refer to Scotland **or** the United Kingdom **or** both.

(c) To what extent are victims the group most affected by crime? **20**

OR

(d) To what extent are non-custodial sentences the most effective in dealing with offenders? **20**

[Now go to SECTION 3 on *page 04*]

MARKS

SECTION 3 — INTERNATIONAL ISSUES — 12 marks

Attempt **ONE** question from 3 (a) **OR** 3 (b) **OR** 3 (c) **OR** 3 (d)

Question 3

Part C: World powers

With reference to a world power you have studied

(a) analyse the effects of socio-economic inequality on a group you have studied. **12**

OR

(b) evaluate the international influence of a world power you have studied. **12**

OR

Part D: World issues

With reference to a world issue you have studied

(c) evaluate the impact of the issue on individuals, families and communities. **12**

OR

(d) analyse the success of international organisations in tackling the issue. **12**

[END OF QUESTION PAPER]